

genres from academics to arts and crafts, farming to film editing, cooking to comedy, design to DIY, and more. That breadth extends to language too—from Bhojpuri and Haryanvi to Kokborok, Santhali and Chokri. "What's amazing about YouTube is that whatever niche interests you on a given day, there are a lot of people with similar interests who produce amazing content for you to learn something new," says Mohan. In the following interview, he tells us exactly how YouTube is helping achieve this.

Q. There is a huge interest in the 'creator ecosystem', especially in the economic value for them. What has been YouTube's India experience in this regard?

India is our largest country in terms of users. Four out of five internet users in India above 18 years use YouTube regularly. It's when I'm on the ground here that I realise what an incredibly vibrant creator economy exists here. I see it in my own personal experience. I went to high school in Lucknow and love Lakhnavi food. Decades later, I came across a YouTuber, Ranveer Brar, who is a foodie, has a food channel, is an amazing chef, and was just making some Lakhnavi *chaat* recipes. It transported me in time, transported me to a place, gave me a connection to a community of people with similar interests and backgrounds. That is how profound YouTube's impact is. And billion times a day. That what really makes it amazing, especially for a young person. It's how you look to consume content, whether from your favourite creators, your favourite sporting event, or your favourite musicians and artists.

Q. What are the reasons for this explosion of content and usage?

There are a couple of fundamental reasons for that. One is that India is such an amazingly creative place. It's a place where storytelling has been deeply rooted in the culture. And I don't mean just Bollywood or the music of today, but for thousands and thousands of years. So, YouTube becomes a stage, if you will, for all these amazing creators. That's really how vibrant it is and not just within India. That storytelling, that culture—from music to film to sports—is also something that is now, thanks to YouTube, getting exported all over the world. So, over 15 per cent of an Indian creator's watch time comes from outside India. That's about 45 billion hours of viewing time. This is a kind of testament to India as a creator nation. The government's vision around having this WAVES—World Audio Visual & Entertainment Summit—is a milestone in this regard.